

FORGE Phase 2 · Week 13 · Session 38 — Media Insert

For the facilitator. Use alongside "Session 38: Mentor Boundaries" in the Phase 2 Facilitator Guide.

Download the videos: forgementors.org/media.html

Session 38 as written runs about 105 minutes. This insert adds a session video, a **scenario video** that acts out one of the guide's ten boundary scenarios, and one talk, which fills the session to two hours.

What's in this insert

- **Video 38A, "Mentor Boundaries"** (1 min 54 s). Boundaries are not walls; what mentors do and don't do, side by side; the drowning man and the rope ("caring without carrying"); "I can care about you without being responsible for you"; and the four times a mentor must break confidentiality. It ends on the guide's question for the lists, *What have you seen go wrong when someone tried to help but didn't know his lane?*, and holds it for 20 seconds.
- **Video 38B, "Scenario 3"** (1 min 16 s). The guide's Scenario 3, acted out in a dorm: your mentee's bunkmate asks what your mentee talks about in your sessions. The video **stops for 20 seconds** on the pairs' question (*Is this within my role as a mentor? If yes, what do I do? If no, what do I do instead?*), then shows one way a mentor could answer, in the guide's words: "That's between me and him. If you ever want to talk about something yourself, I'm here." It ends on the same question for the other scenarios.
- **A talk on caring without carrying:** Amy Cunningham, *Drowning in Empathy: The Cost of Vicarious Trauma* (TEDxSanAntonio, about 12 minutes), on what happens to helpers who absorb the pain of the people they serve. Its title is the session's own picture.

Run of show (120 minutes)

Time	Segment	Min	Notes
0:00	Opening circle	10	As written.
0:10	Video 38A as the Review and Bridge	5	The video carries the bridge ("Boundaries are not walls...") and previews the session. It ends on the question for the lists; move straight into them.
0:15	What Mentors Do and Don't Do	20	As written. The video showed a short version of both lists; build the full lists with the men.
0:35	Emotional Boundaries: Caring Without Carrying	20	As written. The men have seen the drowning picture once; tell it again in your own words and have them repeat the phrase, as the guide says.
0:55	Talk: Amy Cunningham, <i>Drowning in Empathy</i>	13	Introduce it in one sentence: "She spent years helping people in pain. Listen for the moment she realizes she's in the water too."
1:08	Talk discussion	2	One question from below, answered by one or two men.

Time	Segment	Min	Notes
1:10	Confidentiality and Its Limits	15	As written.
1:25	Video 38B , then Exercise: 10 Boundary Scenarios	25	Pair the men up first, then play the video. When it stops on the question, pause the video and give the pairs their 90 seconds; take one or two answers; then play the rest, which shows one way to handle it. Then read the other nine scenarios as written. Scenario 3 is done, so skip it.
1:50	Closing circle	10	As written.

Questions for *Drowning in Empathy*

1. Where in her story does caring turn into carrying? What was the first sign?
2. Which is harder for you: staying on solid ground when a man is in pain, or letting it go when you walk away?

About the scenario video

The two men in Video 38B are actors made for this video; neither is a real person. The mentor's answer is the guide's answer to Scenario 3. The video shows *one* way to handle it, not the only way. If a pair came up with a different answer that keeps the mentee's business private and leaves the door open, say so.

Links, and getting a copy you can play without internet

- *Drowning in Empathy: The Cost of Vicarious Trauma* (Amy Cunningham, TEDxSanAntonio) — **YouTube** (TEDx Talks): <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ZsaorjIo1Yc>

Preview before class. The talk briefly mentions child abuse and a death. It is not about prison. It also looks ahead to tomorrow's session on compassion fatigue.

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Checklist additions

- ☐ Videos 38A and 38B and the talk loaded on the playback device and tested with sound
- ☐ You know where to pause Video 38B (when the question comes up, about 20 seconds in)
- ☐ Talk previewed and cleared under the facility's media rules